



The Honorable Robert F. Kennedy, Jr.
Secretary
U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
200 Independence Avenue, SW
Washington, D.C. 20201

Dear Secretary Kennedy,

The Society for Immunotherapy of Cancer (SITC) appreciates the opportunity to provide comment and feedback on the Request for Information regarding Accelerating the Adoption and Use of Artificial Intelligence as Part of Clinical Care.

SITC is the world's leading member-driven organization specifically dedicated to improving cancer patient outcomes by advancing the science and application of cancer immunotherapy. SITC is a 501(c)(3) not-for-profit medical professional society of influential research scientists, physician scientists, clinicians, patients, patient advocates, government representatives and industry leaders dedicated to improving cancer patient outcomes by advancing the science and application of cancer immunotherapy. Through emphasis on high-caliber scientific meetings; dedication to education and outreach activities; focus on initiatives of major importance in the field; and commitment to collaborations with like-minded domestic and international organizations, government and regulatory agencies, associations and patient advocacy groups, SITC brings together all aspects of the cancer immunology and immunotherapy community. SITC aims to one day make the word "cure" a reality for cancer patients everywhere.

The utilization of Artificial Intelligence (AI) is an opportunity to accelerate progress across the cancer care continuum. SITC is excited by the potential for continued implementation of AI while maintaining the highest standards of patient safety, privacy, and scientific best practices. Based on SITC's collective perspective and expertise, please find comments below regarding the RFI:

Regulatory Considerations of AI Implementation

- **Transparency** regarding the use of large language model (LLM) AI within the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) is important to help accelerate safe adoption across healthcare. As AI use expands into predictive and risk stratification models, imaging and pathology tools, and generative or clinical decision-support systems, visibility into regulatory evaluation and internal use can help set field-wide expectations. Transparency around model purpose, performance, data validation, limitations, updating processes, real-world monitoring, and accountability structures may strengthen trust and support responsible clinical integration.
- **Continued clarity** on how AI model updates over time may affect clinical trial implementation. Clear regulatory expectations for revalidation, documentation, and post-deployment monitoring could help maintain trial integrity and consistent performance. Because single institutions may lack sufficient data to detect rare failures or performance

issues in underrepresented populations, collaborative, multi-institutional evaluation frameworks could support earlier safety detection and more equitable performance assessment.

- **Clear pathways** are critical for sharing AI tools that meet regulatory standards across institutions and could help prevent siloed implementation. Shared validation approaches, standardized performance reporting, and coordinated monitoring may improve access to safe and effective AI-enabled care. Consortium-based models could also support more equitable deployment across healthcare settings while enabling shared learning and continuous performance oversight.

Research and Development Opportunities Through AI Implementation

- **Increased investment** in AI-driven biomarker discovery can accelerate identification of clinically meaningful signals across multi-omic and clinical datasets and support emerging clinical AI applications such as predictive risk models, imaging and pathology tools, and clinical decision-support systems. Safe and effective adoption will require strong transparency standards across model purpose, performance, validation, limitations, updating, and accountability. Supporting collaborative, multi-institutional evaluation can further improve detection of rare failures, ensure performance across unique populations, and promote equitable access to AI-enabled care.
- **Investment in infrastructure** that allows for Bio-banking and sharing of ECQM records for analysis in HIPAA compliant ways can accelerate and enable high-quality AI development, validation, and real-world monitoring. Transparency across data provenance, governance, and intended clinical use can strengthen trust and regulatory confidence. Multi-institutional data-sharing and oversight models can improve detection of safety or performance issues and help prevent fragmented AI implementation across healthcare systems.

SITC is excited to further assist or collaborate on this effort by discussing the above or additional topics presented within the RFI. SITC leaders have vast expertise in immunotherapeutic drug development and have diverse perspectives on the future of cancer care and research.

Thank you for providing an opportunity to provide comment on this important topic. Should you have any questions, please do not hesitate to contact me at mdean@sitcancer.org. We look forward to collaborating in the future on all efforts focused on providing cancer patients with safe and effective treatment options.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Mary Dean". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "Mary" and last name "Dean" clearly distinguishable.

Mary Dean, JD, CAE
Executive Director
Society for Immunotherapy of Cancer